

trolled. You are not going to get eaten by a lion or catch cholera. There's lots of food and you can boogie all night. Carnival has the leading market share in the vacation-cruise business, the most professional management, the highest margins, the most modern ships, the best advertising and marketing to the economy end of the cruise market, and the best relationships with travel agents. Its earnings have been growing 20 percent a year, and will continue to excel, especially if Castro finally packs it in. Cuba's an ideal destination for folks cruising out of Miami.

Collecting the Wages of Sin

In a society determined to have a good time in its leisure hours, with airports, resorts, restaurants, and gambling casinos all doing fine, it would seem that hedonism is triumphant. But public moods go through cycles, the oldest of all cycles—from good to bad and back to good again.

In the 1960s, the good was ascendant. We refer to the altruistic and idealistic sentiments that prevailed then: pacifism, ecology, integration, and antimaterialism. Tens of billions of dollars were allocated to urban renewal, clean air and water, education and training for minorities, worker safety, and other worthy endeavors. I owned a number of stocks of companies that seemed essential to these initiatives.

Then, in the late seventies and the Reagan eighties, the pendulum swung back. As the hippies matured and entered the workforce, they found they wanted to keep their money for themselves instead of paying more taxes. The perfectibility of man and society was now perceived